ontario chamber of commerce

Product Photo's
Best Practices & Tips

What is a Product Photo?

Product photos are proof of the product's characteristic. Your buyers look at product photos first and then read the description to confirm if it is right for them.

Why are Product Photos so Important?

What buyers see is often a deciding factor in whether they will stay on your site. To reach your target audience, you need to include clear, eye-catching photos of your products.

Benefits of Quality Product Photos:

- Helps buyers decide if they will make a purchase
- Increases sales
- Reduces questions buyers may have, as well as the number of returns
- More results on search engines



Fashion Photography Best Practices

- Show the fit by using a model or mannequin
- Include close-ups of patterns & textures
- Show different angles (front/back/top/bottom)
- Show the inside of handbags, backpacks, hats, shoes, etc.
- Show tags, labels, packaging

Product-Only Photography Best Practices

- Use a bright (typically white) backdrop without background clutter
- Show different angles (front/back/top/bottom)
- Shoot with plenty of light (consider taking photos outside)
- Involve pets or children to create a feeling of fun and comfort

Context Photography Best Practices

Context photography showcases how people can use a particular item in real life, which often inspires purchases.

- Market Research - find inspiration from other e-commerce stores to see how they market their products
- Set the Scene - photograph your product where it gets lots of natural light, but avoid harsh sunlight streaming through a window - use a curtain to diffuse the light

Tip Sheet

Backdrop

Use a plain white or neutral backdrop for your photos. This draws the buyers attention to the product instead of its surroundings.





Lighting

You can use natural or artificial lighting. Stage product near a window or use studio lights to ensure the area is fully lit up in a balanced level.

Position the Item

Position your product in front of the background in a way that best showcases it.
For example, if your product is a necklace, display it on a stand where it is stretched out and visually appealing.



Showcase all Angles

Photograph your product from multiple different angles (front, back, left, right, top, bottom, inside).
If this is a resale item, be sure to show any scrapes/rips/scuffs to avoid returns later.

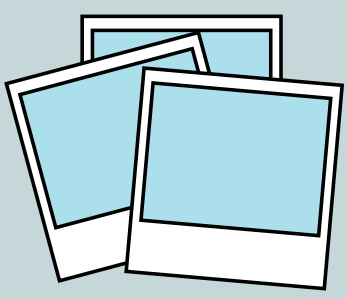


Photo Resolution

Set your camera to the highest quality resolution setting.
You will often see two setting choices on your camera:
Size - choose 'large' for best image quality
Quality - choose 'superfine' to use all available pixels





Photo Editing

DO - retouch images to improve colour saturation and lighting.

DON'T - add filters, decorative elements and overlay images on your photos.

Avoid Props & Clutter

Additional props can obscure, shade or overtake the image of the item. Let your product be the shining star!
It may also confuse the buyer as to exactly what product(s) are included in your listing.



Photo Editing Software

- Fotor
- Pixlr X
- Gimp
- Canva
- Adobe Express
- Photopea

*Please note that the Ontario Chamber of Commerce does not promote or endorse any 3rd party vendors. This resource is provided is for example purposes only.

Product Photography Examples



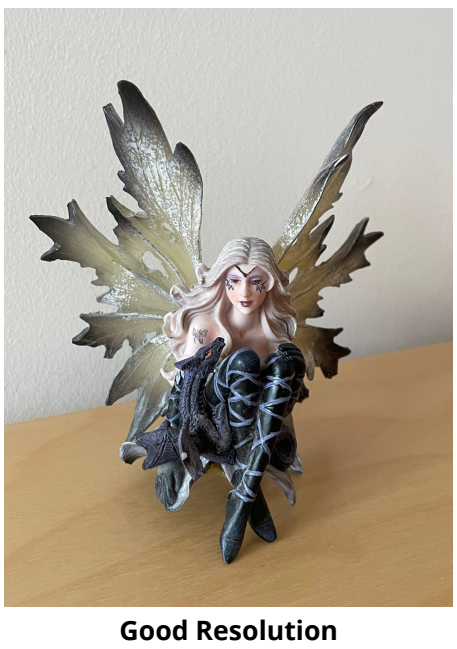
Good Exposure



Over Exposure



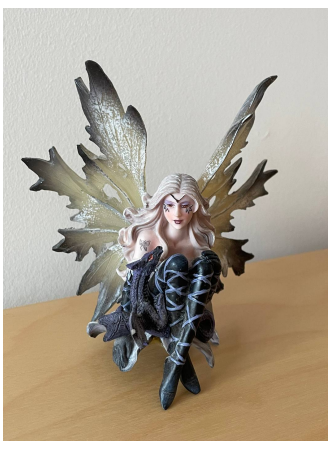
Under Exposure



Good Resolution



Poor Resolution









Show Multiple Angles

Product Photography Tutorials

Product Photography At Home: Beginner to Intermediate Photography Tips | 3 Quick Tips
VIDEO LINK

10 Tips for Better Product Photography
VIDEO LINK

White Background Photography and What You Need to Know!
VIDEO LINK

Creative Product Photography At Home - Beginner To Pro!
VIDEO Link

